

Hair and nails

Made from dead cells packed with a tough substance called keratin, both hair and nails grow from the skin. Millions of hairs grow on your body. These include thicker hairs on your head and finer vellus hairs elsewhere. Nails cover the ends of your fingers and toes, and also help you grip small objects when you pick them up.

BODY PROTECTION

Hairs are flexible strands that have different protective roles according to where they grow. Scalp hairs, for example, protect the head from sunlight. Nails are hard plates that protect and support the sensitive tips of your fingers and toes. Both of these body protectors are made from dead cells, so it doesn't hurt when you get your hair cut or trim your nails.

► EYELASHES

These help protect the eyes by shading them from sunlight and trapping dust particles. Anything that touches the eyelashes triggers blinking.



▼ **VELLUS HAIRS** *These fine hairs make us more sensitive to touch. For example, if an insect lands on vellus hairs you will feel it, warning you that you may be bitten.*



STRAIGHT, WAVY, OR CURLY?

What type of hair you have depends on the shape of your scalp hairs. The shafts of straight hair are round, those of wavy hair are oval, while curly hair shafts are flat. A hair's shape depends on whether it grows from a round, oval, or flat follicle.

Straight hair



Wavy hair



Curly hair

